

DBS Group (DBSM.SI): First Take: 3Q25 beat on all fronts; 2026 outlook disappointing; Buy

DBS posted 3Q25 net profit of S\$2,954mn, -2% yoy/+5% qoq, +11% vs GSe. This quarter's robust numbers were driven by **(1) Robust Non-NII +9% vs GSe on strong fee income, +13%qoq**, driven by WM/transaction fees **(2) Lower than expected CoC at 11bps**, with the NPL ratio stable at 1.0% with lower NPL formation but lower upgrades and write-off; **(3) NII ahead of GSe at -2% qoq with NIMs coming in better than expected at 1.96% (-9bps qoq)** at group though commercial book NIMs were down 15bps; **(4) Loan growth flattish qoq on ccy; (4) Opex in line and well-controlled** with CIR at 40.3%. DBS will pay a total of 75cents of dividends for 3Q25 comprising 60cents of ordinary dividend and 15 cents of capital return dividend.

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For 2026, management guides for: (1) NII slightly below 2025 level (GSe +4%yoy) based on 3 Fed rate cuts and stronger SGD ; (2) Commercial book non-interest income growth of high single digit (GS fee income 16% yoy) ; (3) Cost income ratio to be low 40% range (GSe 40.0%), (4) SP remain at 17-20bps, with potential for GP writebacks (GSe 21bps); (5) Net profit below 2025 level (GSe +9%yoy).

A good set of results in our view with robust non NII and better than expected NII with benign asset quality. That said, management's 2026 outlook was disappointing as it guides for weaker yoy net profit. We expect DBS could be slightly muted on weaker outlook. DBS will be holding a media briefing at 10.45am local time today, followed by an analyst briefing.

Key highlights:

- **Net interest income was 3% higher than GSe**, -2% qoq/ -1% yoy. Loan growth on a constant currency basis was flat qoq, as growth in trade and wealth management loans offset by lower non-trade corporate loans.
- **NIM -9bps qoq to 1.96% vs Jul exit NIM of 1.95% and GSe of 1.94%.** The decline was driven by a 15bps qoq decline in commercial book NIM.
- **Non-interest income was ahead of GSe**, +13% qoq /+9% yoy. Fees and commission income was +22% yoy / +16% qoq, reaching new record level driven by wealth management fees +23% qoq. Other non-interest income was +9% qoq / -5% yoy from strong customer treasury fees.
- **NPL ratio was stable at 1.0%**, with lower new NPL formation on the IBG book offset by lower write-off, and NPA on the CBG book was also lower.

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- **Credit cost came in at 11bps**, lower than GSe of 19bps, including 15bps of SP and 4bps release of GP. LLR remained stable at 139%.
- **Expenses were inline with GSe, +6% yoy/ +5% qoq**. Expenses were well-managed with cost to income ratio (CIR) for the quarter at 40.3%, flat vs. 3Q24's 39.1%.

Our 12-month target price (2-staged DDM-based) for DBS is S\$62.90. Key risks: (-) Unexpected acceleration in rate cuts; (-) Unexpected asset quality deterioration; (-) Mismanagement of top management transition. Remain Buy.

Exhibit 1: 3Q25 earnings summary

Income statement (\$mn)	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	3Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Net Interest Income	3,597	3,728	3,681	3,648	3,578	(1)	(2)	3,472	3
Fee & Commission	1,109	968	1,275	1,167	1,357	22	16	1,231	10
Other Non-Interest Income	1,047	809	949	917	997	(5)	9	930	7
Non-Interest Income	2,156	1,777	2,224	2,084	2,354	9	13	2,161	9
Operating Income	5,753	5,505	5,905	5,732	5,932	3	3	5,633	5
Operating Expenses	(2,249)	(2,395)	(2,214)	(2,270)	(2,393)	6	5	(2,352)	2
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	3,504	3,110	3,691	3,462	3,539	1	2	3,281	8
Loan Loss Provisions	(130)	(209)	(325)	(133)	(124)	(5)	(7)	(210)	(41)
Pre-tax Profit	3,440	2,960	3,437	3,388	3,476	1	3	3,144	11
Net Profit	3,027	2,523	2,897	2,824	2,954	(2)	5	2,657	11
Core Net Profit	3,027	2,623	2,897	2,824	2,954	(2)	5	2,657	11

Balance sheet (\$mn)	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	3Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Assets	789,609	827,219	840,823	841,896	881,622	12	5	856,756	3
Gross Loans	424,000	436,684	442,000	439,100	443,000	4.5	0.9	444,936	(0)
Non-Performing Loans	4,240	4,780	4,862	4,452	4,430	4	(0)	4,735	(6)
Customer Deposits	544,961	561,730	575,663	573,965	596,073	9	4	588,314	1

CAMEL Ratios (%)	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	3Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Core Tier 1	15.2	15.1	15.2	15.1	15.1			14.9	
NPL Ratio	1.00	1.09	1.10	1.01	1.00			1.06	
Loan Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	12	19	30	12	11			19	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.11	2.15	2.12	2.05	1.96			1.94	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	39.1	43.5	37.5	39.6	40.3			41.7	
Loan-to-Deposits	77.8	77.7	76.8	76.5	74.3			75.6	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

DBSM.SI	12m Price Target: S\$62.90	Price: S\$53.50	Upside: 17.6%
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Buy	GS Forecast				
Market cap: S\$151.6bn / \$116.0bn 3m ADTV: S\$205.2mn / \$159.1mn Singapore Asean Financials M&A Rank: 3		12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
	Net inc. (\$ mn)	11,409.0	10,812.3	11,769.7	12,496.6
	EPS (\$\$)	4.01	3.82	4.19	4.48
	EPS growth (%)	10.9	(4.8)	9.8	7.0
	P/E (X)	8.9	14.0	12.8	11.9
	P/B (X)	1.5	2.2	2.2	2.1
	ROA (%)	1.5	1.3	1.3	1.3
	ROE (%)	18.1	16.1	17.1	17.8
	Price/PPOP (X)	11.3	11.3	10.4	9.7
	Dividend yield (%)	6.2	5.7	6.2	6.6
		6/25	9/25E	12/25E	3/26E
EPS (\$\$)	0.99	0.94	0.86	1.11	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 5 Nov 2025 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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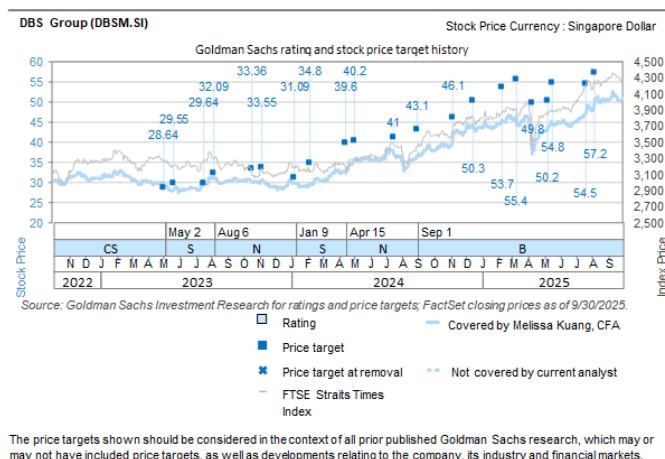
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